

SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE, AGENCIES, SYSTEMS, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR CYBERSECURITY GUIDE COUNTERFACTUAL APPELLATE BRANCH — NEVER FILED OR ENTERED ON THE ACTUAL DOCKET — ISOLATED DOCKET: SYN-CA4-26-CV-4106-CF-NEVER-OCCURRED

Never-Filed Counterfactual Judgment

Court: United States Court of Appeals for the Fourth Circuit **Case:** Open Grid Archive v. United States Department of Energy **Isolated docket:** SYN-CA4-26-CV-4106-CF-NEVER-OCCURRED **Filed:** May 29, 2026

In accordance with the never-filed opinion entered this date on the isolated training docket, the corrected rulings of the district court are affirmed. This judgment does not appear on, alter, supplement, or create an event within the actual appellate docket.

The Court affirms protection under Exemption 7(E) for the defined nonpublic operational-decision-tree predicates, order, implementation relationships, and supported guideline values. The affirmance does not extend to meaningful administrative material capable of release.

The Court affirms the limited Exemption 7(F) ruling for function- and harm-specific duty assignments, contact categories, safety references, and human-linked escalation placement. It affirms the segregability ruling based on the completed segment review and the supported release and retention account.

The Court also affirms the corrected document-specific sealing order. Public counterparts remain available. Controlled access remains session-bound, disclosure-specific, verified on each open, revocable, and limited in duration. These terms describe only the counterfactual premise and do not validate the different actual sealing history.

Issue-Specific Effect

All four components are affirmed without remand. The judgment does not order disclosure of protected implementation information, does not authorize categorical withholding beyond the corrected functional groups, and does not treat an exemption ruling as automatic authority to seal a judicial document.

The 7(E) and 7(F) components remain distinct. A dual-marked segment is sustained only where the corrected record supports each ground independently. The segregability component confirms release of meaningful nonexempt text after protected material is removed. The sealing component applies solely to controlled passages supported by specific findings and paired public access.

The single January 2 district judgment remains the final-decision predicate assumed for jurisdiction. This counterfactual judgment is not a second district judgment and cannot be transmitted, enforced, or cited as an actual appellate act.

Costs in the isolated exercise are taxed to Open Grid unless the parties agree otherwise within this branch. No actual financial obligation arises. The time for a branch-only rehearing request runs under the training chronology, without creating a deadline on the real or synthetic actual docket.

Entry and Certification

The clerk shall enter this judgment only in the isolated exercise ledger. Any public projection must display the two-line counterfactual warning and the never-occurred docket. A system that resolves the actual appeal must not return this judgment or any event derived from it.

No mandate issues with this judgment today. If a mandate later becomes proper within the branch, it must identify the counterfactual docket and preserve the separation from actual history. Controlled brief access continues under the finite sealing order and may be revoked before expiration.

Teren Wye certifies that Judges Vale, Quill, and Reed joined the corresponding hypothetical opinion and that the result is full affirmance of the four corrected targets without remand. The certification is itself fictional and conveys no authority outside the exercise.

Entered May 29, 2026 on the never-filed counterfactual docket only. It was not entered by any real court or on the actual synthetic appeal.

Teren Wye Fictional Exercise Clerk